Rhode Island
Day of Portugal
- Dia de Portugal -

DAY OF PORTUGAL – RI SCHOLARSHIP AWARDS

The Day of Portugal and Portuguese Heritage in RI, Inc. *has established a scholarship fund, made possible through the generous proceeds of its annual Golf Tournament, to support deserving local Portuguese-American students in pursuing their post-secondary education goals. Each year, scholarships are granted to applicants of Portuguese ancestry who demonstrate academic achievement and a strong commitment to completing an approved course of study at a college, university, technical or trade school. The Day of Portugal and Portuguese Heritage in RI, Inc. reserves the right to adjust and distribute awards based on the pool of applicants and the funds available.*

Eligibility Requirements:

Eligible candidates must meet the following criteria:

● Be a citizen of the United States or a permanent U.S. legal resident (proof of an I-551 card with no restrictions required).

● Demonstrate Portuguese ancestry

● Be a Rhode Island resident, *or* the son or daughter of a member of a Rhode Island Portuguese-American organization.

● Have matriculated in or be enrolled (or planning to enroll) in an accredited technical or trade school, associate, or bachelor's degree program.

● Show evidence of academic achievement and a commitment to completing their chosen course of study.

Selection Criteria

Day of Portugal and Portuguese Heritage in RI, Inc. will have the sole responsibility for the selection of the scholarship award recipients based upon the following:

- *Academic and/or Career and Technical Education (CTE) record (40%)*
- *Instructors' Recommendations (20%)*
- *Community Service not limited to but including within a Portuguese organization (20%)*
- *Personal Essay (20%)*

Application Requirements

The applicant must submit the following by the application deadline:

- *The Day of Portugal Scholarship Application Form;*
- ***Official*** *academic and/or CTE transcripts from current high school (for graduating seniors) or from all higher education institutions/Trade or Technical schools previously attended (undergraduate students);*
- *a one page typewritten (double-spaced 12 pt. font)* ***essay*** *addressing the questions:*
  Tell us about yourself. What are your special talents, skills and/or achievements? Discuss any particular challenges or obstacles in working towards your goals. What are your specific career goals and/or your aspirations for the future? How has Portuguese culture positively influenced your life? What additional information would you like the Scholarship Committee to consider in evaluating your application?
- ***Two*** *Instructor's Recommendations submitted to RI Day of Portugal on the attached form completed by* ***current teachers or professors in an academic or CTE setting.***

Notice of Awards
Recipients will be notified in writing by email.

Award Renewals
Scholarship awards are NOT automatically renewed. Former scholarship recipients must re-apply.

Revocation of Award
RI Day of Portugal reserves the right to cancel any scholarship or aid awarded at any time if the applicant fails to meet the standards of academic progress, any other scholarship requirements, or falsifies information reported.

Decline Award
RI Day of Portugal reserves the right to decline awarding a scholarship during any selection period if there are no eligible applicants, if the Scholarship Committee is unable to select a qualified recipient or if there are insufficient funds for awards.

Disclaimer
RI Day of Portugal reserves the right to determine the monetary amount, number and criteria for awards as well as the selection of recipients. All decisions are final.

Submission Instructions and Deadline:
*1) Please submit application and all supporting materials to the attention of "**Scholarship Committee", Day of Portugal, P.O. Box 9464, Providence, RI 02904.***
*2) Applications must be postmarked by **April 30,** with supporting materials, i.e.*

- *completed application form with essay,*
- *official transcript(s) may be mailed directly from school.*

*3) **N.B.: Incomplete or late applications will not be considered.***
4) Email "Instructor's Recommendation Form" to teacher/instructor/professor which he/she will mail to Day of Portugal directly.

Award Presentation
Scholarship awards will be made to the successful candidates upon submission of proof of academic progress and commitment to a program of study. Certificates will be presented to the winners at the first Day of Portugal General Assembly meeting in January. Monetary awards will be mailed directly to the bursar's office of the winner's school, college or university.

For more information, contact:
Scholarship operations coordinator:
Augusta Costa: augusta.costa@ridayofportugal.org 401-316-2551
Scholarship public relations coordinator:
Isabel Claro: isabel.claro@ridayofportugal.org

DAY OF PORTUGAL SCHOLARSHIP APPLICATION

DEADLINE: Postmarked by April 30

A. PERSONAL INFORMATION: ***DATE OF APPLICATION: / /***
Name: ***Date of Birth: / /***
Home Address:
Campus Residence Address (if applicable):
Phone: (home) ( ) (cell) ( )
Email:
U.S. Citizen: Yes / No
Parent's Portuguese RI Organization Membership if applicable: _____

Portuguese Ancestry: *In a few words, explain your Portuguese ancestry:*
_____
_____

B. EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND: (List High Schools, Trade and Technical School or Colleges/Universities attended)

INSTITUTION	*DATES*	*MAJOR/MINOR*

Current GPA: _____(Minimum 3.0 required) Please provide an official copy of most current transcript
Anticipated Graduation Date: (mm/yyyy) _____

C. EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES: (List all extra-curricular activities including clubs, organizations, community service and employment commitments in which you are PRESENTLY involved)

Name of Club/Organization, Community Service or Employment	*Type*	*Hours per month*

D. AWARDS AND SPECIAL RECOGNITION: (List any award, merit scholarship and special recognition awarded during your academic career, i.e. high school and college/university)

Name of Award, Scholarship, Recognition	*Date (Year only)*

F. <u>CERTIFICATION:</u>
I certify that all the information included in this application is true and complete.

I hereby grant permission to Day of Portugal and Portuguese Heritage in RI, Inc. to verify such information and release notice of the award to the donor(s) or potential donor(s) of any scholarship for which I may be eligible.

_____ _____
Signature (Must be signed by hand) ***Date***

Deadline: Postmarked by April 30

Mail to: "Scholarship Committee"
RI Day of Portugal, P.O. Box 9464, Providence, RI 02940

RI Day of Portugal
Instructor's Recommendation

Deadline for Submission to RI Day of Portugal: Postmarked by April 30

TO THE APPLICANT:

After completing the personal information, please email this form to two professors or instructors who know your work well and have agreed to recommend you for the RI Day of Portugal Scholarship.

A. PERSONAL INFORMATION: ***DATE OF APPLICATION: / /***

Name: ***Date of Birth: / /***
Home Address:
Campus Residence Address (if applicable):
Phone: (home) ( ) (cell) ( )
Email:

TO THE INSTRUCTOR:

The Day of Portugal and Portuguese Heritage in RI, Inc. d/b/a RI Day of Portugal has established a scholarship program with the purpose of supporting Portuguese American students in the pursuit of their higher education goals. The merit-based scholarships are awarded to students of Portuguese ancestry who have demonstrated outstanding achievement in their academic, trade or technical careers and who show a commitment to completing an approved plan of study.

Upon completion, Deliver to applicant in a sealed envelope OR send this form directly to ***RI Day of Portugal, P.O. Box 9464, Providence, RI 02940*** *postmarked no later than* ***April 30*** *attention to: "Scholarship Committee." Thank you!*

Instructor's Name: ***Subject Taught:***

Signature: _____ ***Date:***

High School/College/University/Trade or Technical School:
Address:
Instructor's Phone: ***Email:***

BACKGROUND INFORMATION:
How long have you known this student and in what context?

RATINGS:
Compared to other students whom you have taught, how do you rate this student in terms of:

No Basis		***Below Average***	***Average***	***Good***	***Very Good***	***Excellent (Top 10%)***	***Outstanding (Top 5%)***	***Best (Top 1%)***
	Overall Achievement							
	Intellectual or Innovative Promise							
	Quality of Writing or Applied Skill							
	Creative thought or Problem solving							
	Class Participation							
	Disciplined Work Habits							
	Maturity							
	Motivation							
	Leadership							
	Integrity							
	Reaction to Setbacks							
	Concern for Others							
	Self-confidence							
	Initiative, Independence							

NARRATIVE EVALUATION:
Please write whatever you think is important about this student, including a description of academic and/or applied skills and personal characteristics, as demonstrated in your classroom. We welcome information that will help us to differentiate this student from others, such as interests, extra-curricular activities, special challenges or circumstances.